Jarod Govers

Details: jarod.govers [at] unimelb.edu.au www.jarodgovers.com www.linkedin.com/in/jarod-govers/

Personal Summary
Solving social issues with AI requires a two-step approach, identifying how the potential risks of using AI to solve the issue and how to resolve them. My passion is in new technologies, particularly chatbots and GenAI, in the field of Human-Computer Interaction, and how we can observe the potential harms and solutions to their biases. The flexibility of my interdisciplinary studies and employment background drives my desire to work in collaborative research and development roles.

My PhD investigates strategies, qualities and risks of using conversational generative AI to address online polarisation and develop responsible AI. These GenAI approaches include proactive measures such as online conflict mediators, anthropomorphic online chatbots, trust calibration for AI/LLMs and AI-for-teams; as well as risks that these technologies could exploit human bias. My research aims to reduce online divisions without resorting to ambulance-at-the-bottom-of-the-cliff reactive measures by addressing the grievances that result in an escalating online conflict.

Professional Skills

- Designing and conducting human-interaction studies with chatbots and interactive games
    - Including online interactive studies and in-person codesign workshops with industry
- Social and technical policy writing and analysis (technical briefing papers, papers, public policy)
- Machine Learning and Data Mining competency (PyTorch, Keras, TensorFlow, Weka)
- Competency in Python, C#, C/C++, Java, Scala, Android Development, R, Git, GitLab
- Networking and cyber-security knowledge (reverse engineering, penetration testing)
- Database design, SQL and NoSQL programming (Oracle, SQL Server, MongoDB)

Behavioural Skills

- Entrepreneurial and innovative
- Team-oriented and passionate
- Organised, strong attention to detail
- Confident and effective communicator

Education History

PhD in Human Computer Interaction at the University of Melbourne (2023-~July 2026, 3rd [final] year).
Master of Cyber Security at the University of Waikato (2021-22) **GPA 9.0/9.0** [A+ on every course].
Bachelor of Science (Technology) at the University of Waikato – **GPA 9.0/9.0** [A+ on every course].

Publications (as First Author Only):

When and How AI Should Assist Brainstorming for AI Impact Assessment

- Just accepted for the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency 2026.
- Paper completed during Nokia Bell Labs internship which investigates how AI can augment team brainstorming to help developer teams identify potential benefits, risks and their mitigations, during AI design – helping ensure responsible AI requirements from the EU AI Act.

Narratives and Perspectives: How AI Summaries Steer Users' Opinions and Engagement on Social Media

- 🏆 Received a CHI26' Best Paper Award 🏆
- Published in the premier ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) 2026.
- Investigated the potential for AI summaries of comment sections in social media can unduly influence user perceptions by giving undue sense of balance to fringe opinions or reinforcing mob mentality depending on their design.

The Manchurian Companion: How Anthropomorphised Chatbots Influence Users' Susceptibility to Bias

- Under review as of January 2026.

- Investigated the risks of AI-driven indoctrination caused by anthropomorphic digital assistant and companion chatbots, extending on the risks of biased news chatbots in the prior Feeds of Distrust paper.
- Identified that social presence and perceived trustworthiness attained by anthropomorphic chatbot design and prior interactions increases a user's susceptibility to their chatbot's biases/ideology.

Feeds of Distrust: Investigating How AI-Powered News Chatbots Shape User Trust and Perceptions

- Published in ACM Transactions in Intelligent Systems (2025).
- Investigated the potential and risks of biased news chatbots in manipulating public opinion, where our results identified that the interactive agency afforded to by chatbots leads users makes users more susceptible to bias and political indoctrination than the static online print news media.
  https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3722227

AI-Driven Mediation Strategies for Audience Depolarisation in Online Debates

- Published in the premier ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) 2024
- Developed psychology-driven mediation chatbots to reduce polarisation in online debates.
  https://doi.org/10.1145/3613904.3642322

Down the Rabbit Hole: Detecting Online Extremism, Radicalisation, and Politicised Hate Speech

- Published in the Association of Computing Machinery (ACM) Computing Surveys Journal (CSUR).
- Investigated the state-of-the-art Natural Language Processing, non-textual community detection (graph/network) models, and visual image-detection approaches to Extremism, Radicalisation and Hate speech (ERH) detection in a social and computational framework – coined as ERH Context Mining.
  https://doi.org/10.1145/3583067

Prompt-GAN – Customisable Hate Speech and Extremist Datasets via Radicalised Neural Language Models

- ACM-published ICCAI 2023 conference – https://doi.org/10.1145/3594315.3594366
- Involved generating synthetic hate speech posts and tweets using a Generative Adversarial Networks built on language transformers. Setting a record in hate speech detection.

Employment History

June 2025-Sept 2025 Research Intern at Nokia Bell Labs (Cambridge UK):
Designed and ran fifteen collaborative codesign workshops with industry and researchers to develop AI tools to help development teams design and brainstorm responsible AI (particularly to help teams design AI in a way that ensures ethical and legal compliance with the EU AI Act). Output study under-review.
June 2023-Present Sessional Tutor and Demonstrator for the University of Melbourne (Part-time)
For holding tutorials and sessions for Foundations in Computing, and Fundamentals of Interaction Design.

Aug 2022-Feb 2023 Infrastructure Support Engineer for Fonterra (Full-time)
Role involved proactive design and maintenance, alongside on-demand support for systems, security, and network architectures for servers and virtualised environments.

Feb 2022-Aug 2022 Graduate Assistant for the University of Waikato (Part-time)
Head tutor of the COMPX553 'Extremely Parallel Programming' post-graduate course. Required organisational planning and communication skills enhanced by my experience as a lab assistant.

Mar 2020-Feb 2022 Lab Assistant for the University of Waikato (Part-time)
Employed to tutor and mark students' laboratory work for six Computer Science courses.

Nov 2020-Feb 2021 Junior Design Engineer (Critical Communications Performance Monitoring Internship)
Involved metadata analysis of Tait Digital Modular Radio Base Stations, Siemens Gateways and Tait Nodes for automated performance monitoring and reporting of critical communication infrastructure.

Awards and Achievements

2026:

- Best Paper Award – CHI26' Conference (Top 1%).

2024:

- Best Presentation Award – 10th CIS Doctoral Colloquium at the University of Melbourne.

2023:

- University of Melbourne Ingenium Scholarship.

2022:

- Attained highest-possible GPA across both Bachelor's and Master's (with First Class Honours).

2021:

- APEC 2021 Voices of the Future Delegation – representing NZ youth on behalf of the University of Waikato in cyber-diplomacy for the NZ-hosted Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation 2021 summit.
- University of Waikato Research Masters Scholarship – based on prior academic achievement.

2020:

- Lewis Fretz Prize in International Relations.
- Golden Key Academic Honors Society Membership Offer.

2019:

- University of Waikato Dean's Award for Excellence.

Volunteering/Contributions

2025:

- Session chair for CHI25 'Decision Making with AI'.
- Student Volunteer for HRI25' (ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction).
- Associate Chair (1AC) for CHI25' Late Breaking Work Committee.
- Reviewer for DIS25, CSCW25, CHI26.

2023/24:

- Student Volunteer for CHI24' (ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems).
- Reviewer for CHI24', CHI25' and ICWSM24', ICWSM25' (AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media).
- Student Volunteer for Melbourne Computing and Information Systems Doctoral Colloquium.

2019-2022:

- University of Waikato Academic Board, Divisional, and Class Representative.

2015-2022:

- Delegate and volunteer for the United Nations Youth New Zealand.

2015-2019:

- New Zealand Cadet Forces – No. 10 Sqd. Air Training Corps.

Interests

I have a passion for emerging technologies such as Virtual Reality and flight simulation, as well as music, games and anime. My spark to be inquisitive extends into global issues, particularly cyber and international security, which are also favourite pastimes as I strive to keep in the loop. I love to bring people together, as I have a passion for talking to people as much as my studies makes me talk to computers all day.